

Chirag Yadav

 [linkedin.com/in/chirag93](https://www.linkedin.com/in/chirag93) |  [chirag-ydv.github.io](https://github.com/chirag-ydv) |  (646) 226-9070 |  cyadav5@uic.edu

Professional Profile

Applied economist with five years of full-time experience conducting and managing economic and policy research for government and private-sector clients, complemented by doctoral training in applied microeconomics and causal inference. Experienced in leading research teams, developing empirical methodologies, and translating quantitative analysis into policy-facing reports and presentations.

Education

University of Illinois Chicago PhD, Applied Economics; GPA: 3.84/4.00 Fields: Labor Economics, Economics of Education, Applied Microeconomics.	Chicago, IL <i>Expected May 2027</i>
South Asian University MA, Economics	New Delhi, India <i>May 2016</i>
University of Delhi BA (Hons.), Economics	New Delhi, India <i>July 2014</i>

Teaching Experience

University of Illinois Chicago <i>Course Instructor</i>	Chicago, IL <i>Jul 2023 – May 2026</i>
- Teach and manage a 220-student undergraduate/graduate microeconomics course; supervise two teaching assistants and coordinate course timelines, assessments, and delivery. - Design course content and communicate economic concepts and quantitative reasoning to audiences with varied technical backgrounds.	
<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	<i>Aug 2021 – May 2023</i>
Led weekly discussion sections for 60+ undergraduate students over four consecutive semesters.	

Selected Applied Research

School Ratings and Enrollment Choices of Limited English Proficient Families	<i>Job Market Paper</i>
- Examine how publicly reported school-quality ratings affect enrollment decisions and whether language-access barriers limit families' ability to respond to public information. - Combine restricted-use Texas administrative student records with school-accountability data and exploit statutory rating thresholds in a regression discontinuity design. - Find limited enrollment response among Hispanic LEP families to ratings alone while non-LEP students respond positively; explore heterogeneity across local school-choice environments and LEP concentration.	

Family Responses to School Accountability Ratings <i>with Gregory Phelan, Javaeria Qureshi and Steve Rivkin</i>	<i>Working Paper</i>
- Use a regression discontinuity design around Texas accountability-rating thresholds to estimate how school-quality information affects enrollment and student mobility. - Find that higher ratings increase enrollment primarily through incoming transfers and new entrants, with stronger responses when ratings are more informative about families' own student groups.	

Unions & Market Power: Evidence from Right-to-Work Laws	<i>Ongoing Research</i>
Combine job-posting data with Quarterly Workforce Indicators to study how reductions in union power interact with local labor-market concentration to affect labor-market outcomes.	

Professional Experience

Institute for Competitiveness

Gurgaon, India

Research Manager

Jul 2020 – Jun 2021

- Led and managed teams of 10+ researchers on economic, policy, and strategy engagements for government and private-sector clients; oversaw project planning, task allocation, analytical quality control, and timely delivery.
- Designed and delivered data and methodology workshops for 40+ officials from India's Ministry of Housing and NITI Aayog, translating quantitative methods and research findings for government and policy audiences.
- Ease of Living Index 2020: Collaborated with city data officers across 111 Indian cities to develop India's official data portal covering 400+ livability indicators and helped develop the methodology and estimation procedures used to compare cities and municipalities.
- Contributed to research projects spanning urban, industrial, and social policy, working across survey design, methodology development, data analysis, and client-facing research delivery.

Data Analyst

Aug 2016 – Jun 2020

- Automated extraction and processing of data from databases and web-based sources using Python scripts and Excel workflows, reducing data-processing time by approximately 10 hours per person per project.
- Adapted empirical research methodologies to client-specific economic and policy questions while maintaining analytical rigor and data accuracy.
- Contributed to policy reports, methodology documents, quantitative analyses, and client-facing research deliverables for public- and private-sector engagements.

Technical Skills

Methods: Econometrics, causal inference, regression discontinuity, panel-data analysis, statistical modeling, data analytics, data visualization.

Software: Proficient in Stata, R, Excel; familiar with Python, SQL, Tableau.

Selected Publications

Book: **The Age of Awakening: The Story of the Indian Economy since Independence** (2019).

Co-authored with Amit Kapoor; published by Penguin India.

Case Study: **Innovation and Intellectual Property Rights: The Case of India** (2019). Co-authored with Amit Kapoor and Manisha Kapoor; published in partnership with Property Rights Alliance (PRA).

Presentations & Leadership

Mock Expert Witness, PhD Summer Symposium, Edgeworth Economics Jun 2024

Presented a case study on the Indian economy at a Brenthurst Foundation workshop, Kenya Jun 2023

Graduate Student Council Member, University of Illinois Chicago 2023 – 2024

Honors & Awards

Graduate Mitch Krask Award for Excellence in Undergraduate Teaching, University of Illinois Chicago 2026

Research Scholarship, Institute for Competitiveness 2021

University Medal, University of Delhi 2014